

Japan Daily Brief

Thursday, September 24, 2026

1,872 words · 7 min read

RE: Takaichi-Trump UNGA summit · JGB yields at 30-year high · Typhoon Dujuan kills 10 · DPRK hypersonic test · China rebuffs enemy-state removal

NIKKEI 225

65,513.99

▲ +3.20%

USD/JPY

158.74

▲ +1.67%

BRENT

\$104.41

▲ +4.06%

BOJ RATE

1.25%

• TOP STORIES

DEFENSE

Typhoon Dujuan kills 10, leaves 4 missing across eastern Japan; flooding and landslides hit Chiba and Kanagawa

Typhoon Dujuan made landfall in eastern Japan, killing at least *10 people* and leaving 4 missing, with search and rescue operations concentrated in Chiba and Kanagawa prefectures where landslides struck residential areas. The storm also flooded agricultural fields and damaged crops in Chiba, according to NHK and Kyodo reporting.

per NHK: "Typhoon Dujuan leaves 10 dead, 4 missing in eastern Japan - nhk.or.jp"

NHK

ECONOMY-BOJ

Japan 10-year JGB yield climbs to highest level since 1996 as global bond rout deepens

Japan's 10-year government bond yield rose to its highest point since September 1996, driven by spillover from rising US interest rates and renewed yen weakness pushing USD/JPY toward the 160 level. Bloomberg separately reports that Japanese yen intervention risk is re-emerging, with Finance Minister **Satsuki Katayama** stating that the principles of Japan-US FX intervention coordination remain in place.

per Bloomberg: "Japan 10-Year Yield Climbs to 1996 High as Global Rout Deepens - Bloomberg.com"

BLOOMBERG

DPRK

North Korea tests upgraded hypersonic missile system; Kim Jong Un calls it 'incurable headache' for adversaries

North Korea conducted what KCNA described as a test of an upgraded hypersonic weapon system following two ballistic missile launches on September 20; outside analysts assess the system as an apparent HGV-equipped Hwaseongpho-11 variant. **Kim Jong Un** lauded the test, and North Korea's foreign minister separately declared the country's nuclear commitment 'irreversible,' while Japan at the UNGA called the nuclear and missile programs a serious threat to global security.

per news.usni.org: "North Korea Tests New Hypersonic Missile - news.usni.org"

DEFENSE

Takaichi grows cautious on setting explicit GDP-based defense spending target

Prime Minister Takaichi has grown reluctant to commit to a fixed GDP percentage target for defense spending, Nikkei Asia reports, signaling a potential shift from the trajectory set under the December 2022 Three Strategic Documents review. The posture comes as Japan's ongoing Three Strategic Documents review is underway and as Takaichi navigates coalition arithmetic following the September 17 cabinet reshuffle.

per Nikkei Asia: "Japan's Takaichi grows cautious of setting GDP defense spending target"

NIKKEI ASIA

• STAT OF THE DAY

1996

Japan 10-year JGB yield hits highest level since September 1996

The yield surge reflects spillover from rising US rates and a weakening yen, with the Bloomberg headline noting the global bond rout deepening.

Japan 10-Year Yield Climbs to 1996 High as Global Rout Deepens — Bloomberg

• JAPANESE GOVERNMENT

KANTEI/PM · CABINET · MOFA · MOD · METI · MOF · BOJ · DIET · THURSDAY, SEPTEMBER 24, 2026

PM Watch: PM appeared today · 0 day(s) since last confirmed appearance — Prime Minister Takaichi delivered Japan's UNGA address calling for removal of 'enemy state' clauses, held a bilateral with Trump, met Turkish President Erdogan to confirm defense equipment cooperation, and separately avoided being drawn into discussion of US ICC sanctions during her Trump meeting.

内閣官房（官邸） · PRIME MINISTER'S OFFICE (KANTEI) · *Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi*

Takaichi meets Turkish President Erdogan on UNGA sidelines, confirms defense equipment cooperation

Prime Minister Takaichi held a bilateral with Turkish President Recep Tayyip Erdogan on the sidelines of the UN General Assembly in New York, confirming cooperation in the defense equipment sector.

→ [Asahi](#) ↗

内閣官房長官 · CHIEF CABINET SECRETARY · *Chief Cabinet Secretary Minoru Kihara*

Kihara states Japan will monitor US-China summit 'with utmost attention'

Chief Cabinet Secretary **Minoru Kihara**, at the September 24 morning press conference, said Japan will monitor the upcoming Trump-Xi summit in the United States with the utmost attention, reflecting Tokyo's concern about any bilateral deal that could affect Japan's security interests.

防衛省 · MINISTRY OF DEFENSE

JSDF transport vessel Kunisaki arrives off Kalimantan coast for Indonesia disaster relief

The Japan Self-Defense Forces transport vessel Kunisaki moved to a position off Kutapang, Kalimantan Island, in connection with international emergency disaster relief operations in Indonesia, per MOD press releases dated September 20-23.

DIET SESSIONS / LDP

HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES / RULING BLOC

Mainichi editorial warns ruling bloc against forcing through self-serving electoral reform

The Mainichi Shimbun editorial board called on Japan's ruling coalition not to push electoral-system changes that benefit incumbents through cross-party talks on the House of Representatives electoral system, as parties work toward a conclusion in the next Diet session.

LDP

LDP proposes mandatory prior review of land purchases near SDF facilities

The LDP circulated a policy recommendation calling for pre-approval screening of land acquisitions around Self-Defense Forces bases and other sensitive facilities, with a legal amendment to follow.

• PUBLIC SENTIMENT & APPROVAL POLLING

POLLSTER	APPROVE	DISAPPROVE
ANN · Sep 23, 2026	58.3%	27.6%
Kyodo · Sep 23, 2026	53.4%	30.9%
Nikkei · Sep 5, 2026	62%	33%
Yomiuri · Sep 19, 2026	59%	30%
FNN · Sep 15, 2026	61.6%	32.2%
NHK · Sep 10, 2026	52.8%	30.8%
JNN · Sep 7, 2026	62.5%	34.9%
Asahi · Sep 5, 2026	53%	33%

Discourse: With a new opposition grouping (Minshukaikaku) launching with only 18 members and without key former DPP figures, and the LDP exploring renewed ties with Komeito, the opposition fragmentation is opening space for LDP to rebuild working Diet majorities ahead of the next ordinary session.

Poll tracker: **Observing Japan approval-rating aggregator** →**• BUSINESS & ECONOMY**

TECH · CNBC · SOFTBANK GROUP, OPENAI

SoftBank issues \$11.1 billion in bonds to fund OpenAI investment; shares jump over 7%

SoftBank Group raised *\$11.1 billion* through a bond issuance to finance the final tranche of its \$30 billion investment in OpenAI, sending its shares up more than 7% on the day.

MACRO · REUTERS

Japan factory activity growth slows in September, PMI shows

Japan's manufacturing PMI showed factory activity growth slowing in September, per Reuters, adding to caution about the pace of industrial recovery amid rising bond yields and a weakening yen.

AUTO · REUTERS · HONDA

Honda plans \$2.5 billion hybrid vehicle plant in Ohio

Honda plans to invest *\$2.5 billion* to build a hybrid vehicle manufacturing facility in Ohio, per Nikkei reporting cited by Reuters, continuing the wave of Japanese automaker investment in US manufacturing under the Trump administration's trade framework.

MANUFACTURING · THE JAPAN TIMES

Japanese food manufacturers boost US investments as demand for Japanese cuisine grows

Japanese direct investment in US food manufacturing stood at *\$8.19 billion* as of end-2025, approximately 2.5 times the level a decade earlier, as Japanese food companies expand US production capacity to meet rising consumer demand.

REGIONAL PRESSURE WATCH WATCH

Heavy — 29 items (4 Japanese government, 25 DPRK-related adversary signal)

CHINA

China's Foreign Ministry spokesperson, in the September 23 regular press conference, directly refuted Takaichi's UNGA call to remove the 'enemy state' clauses, declaring them 'extremely relevant today' and framing Japan's security posture as renewed militarism. Global Times published an editorial stating Takaichi's 'open provocation further proves that the enemy state clauses must not be removed,' while separately a Global Times piece pushed Beijing's historical narrative on Ryukyu, sustaining China's multi-front pressure on Japan's international legal standing and territorial identity.

NORTH KOREA

North Korea claimed a successful test of an upgraded hypersonic missile system following two ballistic missile launches on September 20; KCNA described the weapon as a 'new-type weapon' and Janes assessed it as an apparent HGV-equipped Hwaseongpho-11 variant. Kim Jong Un called the system an 'incurable headache' for adversaries, and North Korea's foreign minister declared nuclear weapons would be kept 'forever,' while Japan at the UNGA called the programs a serious threat to global security and urged complete denuclearization.

"Enemy state clauses in UN Charter remain extremely relevant today"

Chinese Foreign Ministry spokesperson (via Global Times) · Enemy state clauses in UN Charter remain extremely relevant today: Chinese FM refutes Takaichi's remarks at UN — Global Times

"incurable headache"

Kim Jong Un · North Korea's Kim Jong Un lauds apparent hypersonic missile test, calls it 'incurable headache' for foes — CBS News

Bottom line: North Korea's claimed hypersonic missile test and China's pointed rejection of Takaichi's UNGA 'enemy state' push constitute simultaneous dual-vector pressure on Japan's security environment in the week before the Trump-Xi summit; Beijing's insistence on preserving the clauses signals they remain a live diplomatic weapon, not a legal relic.

• U.S.-JAPAN RELATIONS

ALLIANCE · NIKKEI ASIA

Takaichi raised China concerns with Trump but faces risk that Washington cuts a separate deal with Beijing

Prime Minister Takaichi used the UNGA bilateral to press US concerns about China's regional behavior, but Nikkei Asia reports Tokyo remains wary that the Trump-Xi summit could produce arrangements that sideline Japanese interests — a posture confirmed by Chief Cabinet Secretary Kihara's statement that Japan will monitor the summit 'with utmost attention.'

ALLIANCE · THE JAPAN TIMES

Abduction families ask Trump to raise North Korea abductions in any Trump-Kim talks; US officials signal continued support

Families of Japanese citizens abducted by North Korea asked President Trump to raise the abduction issue in any prospective Trump-Kim talks, and US officials stated they would continue to support the immediate resolution of the abductions — an issue Japan has pressed at every bilateral opportunity.

• INDO-PACIFIC PARTNERS

TRILATERAL · YONHAP

US announces SMR deployment implementation plan with South Korea and Japan

The United States announced a trilateral implementation plan with South Korea and Japan for small modular reactor deployments, advancing clean-energy and energy-security cooperation among the three allies.

INDIA · JAPAN FORWARD

India and Japan chart expanded maritime alliance across the Indo-Pacific via shipbuilding and LNG tanker cooperation

Shipbuilding and gas tanker partnerships are emerging as the structural basis for a deepening India-Japan maritime alliance, with the two countries coordinating on port development and energy security across the Indo-Pacific.

QUAD · NIKKEI ASIA

Japan's JERA leads \$2 billion LNG power project proposed for Hawaii

Japan's JERA is leading a \$2 billion proposal to supply LNG-based power generation to Hawaii, representing a direct contribution to US energy infrastructure by a major Japanese utility under the broader US-Japan strategic investment framework.

• EXPERT ANALYSIS AND EVENTS

OP-EDS & THINK TANK COMMENTARY

ATLANTIC COUNCIL

Building a multilateral cognitive warfare defense network: A collaborative framework for the United States, Japan, and Taiwan

The US, Japan, and Taiwan should build a joint multilateral framework for cognitive warfare defense to counter disinformation and information operations threatening the democratic alliance.

The piece argues that the three partners face a shared threat from state-sponsored cognitive warfare and proposes a collaborative institutional framework for joint defense. It addresses the cross-domain challenge that China and North Korea's information operations pose to alliance cohesion. The framework proposed would complement kinetic deterrence with resilience against disinformation targeting public opinion in all three societies.

SO WHAT Directly relevant as Japan's Three Strategic Documents review considers information and cognitive domains alongside conventional deterrence — the framework proposed would require Diet legislation and US-Japan-Taiwan coordination channels that do not currently exist in formal treaty form.

• SOCIAL STATEMENTS



Kim Jong Un

Supreme Leader, North Korea · CBS News · Sep 24, 2026

"incurable headache"

Analyst: Kim's characterization followed KCNA's claim of a successful upgraded hypersonic missile test after two ballistic missile launches on September 20; outside analysts assess the weapon as an HGV-equipped Hwaseongpho-11 variant per Janes.

• UPCOMING

Sep
26

Trump-Xi Washington summit

President Trump and Chinese President Xi Jinping are scheduled to meet in the United States; Tokyo has stated it will monitor 'with utmost attention,' concerned a US-China bilateral deal could affect Japanese security and trade interests.

Oct
1

Japan's new fiscal-year defense budget implementation begins (estimate)

Japan's defense buildup programs, including Nansei island deployments and counterstrike capability procurement, continue under the JFY2026 budget; MOD review of the Three Strategic Documents is ongoing.

Oct
15

Next BOJ Monetary Policy Meeting (estimate)

The BOJ's next scheduled policy board meeting will be watched closely as Japan's 10-year JGB yield hits a 30-year high and the yen weakens toward 160 per dollar, raising questions about the pace of further rate normalization.

Nov
1

Fall extraordinary Diet session expected (estimate)

The fall extraordinary Diet session is anticipated to address electoral reform legislation, the LDP-Komeito cooperation framework, and the Three Strategic Documents defense review — the new opposition grouping Minshukaikaku will sit as the fifth-largest lower-house force.

Dec
1

Cabinet draft defense budget due (estimate)

Japan's annual defense budget cycle calls for a Cabinet draft in December; the outcome will reflect whether Takaichi maintains or modifies the 2%-of-GDP spending trajectory she is reported to be reconsidering.

CSIS Japan Chair

JAPAN DAILY BRIEF

Washington, D.C.

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